

ERP System Implementation Project (Odoo)

Watan Designs Limited, Kingdom of Saudi Arabia

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Dubai in Cairo Ltd.

For Digital Marketing and eCommerce Services

Odoo Project Management Module (Chapter 06)

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6.0 Project Management and Task Organization

1.1 Introduction and Objectives

The project management system is one of the core modules in the Odoo ecosystem, and it aims to organize and monitor all the activities and stages that projects go through from the planning stage to the final delivery stage.

This system helps to define the scope of each project, the resources involved, and the approved timelines, ensuring improved execution quality, reduced errors, and integration between different departments within the factory.

The Projects Module is used in our Factories to link sales with the design department on one hand, and the design department with production on the other hand, as the system allows for accurate tracking of each stage, documentation of tasks, and setting of schedules and costs for design tasks for a specific project.

System Objectives

- Unifying the management of all projects within a single platform that connects the operational and administrative departments.
- Defining the time phases for each project and accurately monitoring progress in real time.
- Distribute tasks and responsibilities among team members while setting work priorities.
- Linking projects to human resources and “time records” to calculate the operating cost for each project.

- Supporting management decisions through interactive dashboards and performance reports.
- Facilitating internal communication between work teams through tasks, notes, and comments within the system.
- Improving adherence to deadlines and reducing delivery delays.
- Documenting all project phases and implementation results to facilitate future review processes.

1.2 Basic Terms and Concepts

Term	Translation	Administrative Explanation
Project (Initiative)	مشروع أو مبادرة	It is the general framework that brings together a set of tasks and processes related to a specific goal.
Project Stage (Project Phase)	مرحلة أساسية أو خطوة تنفيذية	The project is divided into logical phases such as (inspection – design – execution – delivery). Each phase contains specific tasks to facilitate monitoring and control.
Planned Date (Scheduled Date)	الموعد المخطط أو الموعد المتوقع	The expected start or end date of the project is used to compare the actual time with the planned time when analyzing performance.
Allocated Hours (Assigned Time)	الساعات المخصصة	The hours allocated for the complete execution of the project are used in performance reports to calculate the compliance rate.
Access Rights Setting	صلاحيات المستخدم أو صلاحية الوصول	It determines who can see or modify the project. It helps maintain confidentiality and organize roles.

Dashboard (Analytics Panel)	لوحة المتابعة أو لوحة التحليل	An analytical interface that displays key performance indicators helps managers track progress and make immediate, data-driven decisions to ensure work is on track.
Task (Assignment)	مهمة أو بند عمل	The basic executive unit within the project as each task is assigned to a specific administrator and its progress is tracked within the system.
Sub-Task	مهمة فرعية أو تقسيم المهمة	It is used to divide a large task into smaller, easier-to-manage and follow-up tasks, so that each part has a separate timetable.
Task Dependency	علاقة تبعية أو ارتباط المهام	The sequence in which tasks are performed defines their dependencies; certain tasks must be finished before others can start. These essential relationships are key to accurate project planning.
Task Status	حالة المهمة أو مرحلة التنفيذ	It describes the current stage a task has reached within its overall work cycle in the project. Example: "new", "ongoing", "completed", "cancelled".
Recurring Task (Repetitive Task)	مهمة متكررة أو دورية	A task that is automatically repeated according to a fixed schedule (daily, weekly, monthly) without needing to be created manually each time. It is commonly used for routine activities.
Kanban View (Board View)	عرض البطاقات أو عرض الأعمدة	A visual display showing stages and tasks in cards that can be dragged between columns to easily update the status.
Billable Project (Chargeable Work)	مشروع قابل للفوترة أو مشروع مدفوع	A project whose costs are calculated and sent to the client in the form of invoices, such as design or

		installation projects that are priced by the hour or by the task.
Forecast (Prediction)	التنبؤ بالتنفيذ أو توقع التقدم	A feature that shows the expected progress in the project based on completed and defined tasks, and helps predict delays before they occur.
Milestone (Achievement Point)	نقطة إنجاز رئيسية أو محطة مفصلية	A significant event within the project indicates the achievement of a key part of the objective, such as the completion of the design phase or the delivery of the prototype.
Assignee (Responsible Person)	الشخص المسؤول عن المهمة	This is the user who is assigned to perform the task and receives update notifications and deadlines.
Deadline (Due Dates)	الموعد النهائي أو موعد التسليم	The deadline for completing the task. This helps in monitoring adherence to dates and analyzing the reasons for delays.
Priority (Importance Level)	الأولوية أو درجة الأهمية	It is used to distinguish critical tasks from routine ones (high – medium – low). It helps the manager prioritize tasks.
Timesheet (Work Log)	سجل الساعات أو جدول العمل	A tool for documenting the actual number of hours a task took. It is used to calculate human cost and time commitment.
Burndown Chart (Progress Graph)	مخطط الأداء الزمني	A graph showing the number of tasks completed and remaining over time to track the team's progress on the project.

1.3 The Work Cycle Within The Project Management System

Stage	Activity	Explanation
1	Project Establishment and Defining Scope	The cycle begins by defining the project and its scope, such as developing a bedroom design for client Abdullah Al-Anzi. The project team is then assigned to the system.
2	Timeline Planning and Distribution of Tasks	The project is divided into clear time phases (such as design, review, approval, manufacturing, and delivery), and the key tasks within each phase are defined. This planning aims to ensure clear responsibilities and prioritization.
3	Appointing Staff and Distribution of Roles	Staff are assigned according to their specialization (design, production, site visit). The project manager distributes roles based on their vision and the appropriate competencies.
4	Implementation and Monitoring Daily Progress	Tasks are executed according to the approved schedule, with daily performance monitored through progress dashboards. Corrective actions must always be taken to ensure smooth workflow without delays.
5	Productivity Measurement and Cost Monitoring	Management monitors working hours and resources used for each task or phase, to assess performance efficiency and identify deviations from the original plan.
6	Administrative Follow-Up and Coordination	Periodic meetings are held to review project progress and discuss common departmental issues to unify the vision and improve communication.
7	Analysis and Reports Periodicity	Weekly reports are provided on the project's progress, completion rates, costs, and reasons for deviations.
8	Accreditation and Final Review	After all tasks are completed, the project manager reviews the results and ensures that operational and technical requirements have been met.

		The results are then submitted to the general manager or client for final approval and delivery.
9	Project Closure and Data Documentation	After the project is officially approved, it is administratively closed and all final documents and reports are documented within the Odoo archive. Lessons learned are recorded to improve the management of future projects.

1.4 Practical Operating Procedures (Step-by-Step)

A. Creating a new project and its basic setup

1. From the application panel, select Projects and then press "Create".
2. Write the project name, specify the client, and assign a Project Manager.
3. Enter the time ranges, such as "Planned Start" and "Planned End".
4. Activate "Billable" if the project is paid, then Save.

B. Configuring Project Settings

1. From within the project, open the "Settings" tab.
2. Activate "Timesheets" to record hours.
3. Activate "Task Dependencies" to link tasks, and "Sub-Tasks" to break down tasks.
4. Choose the appropriate Visibility: Internal, Project Members Only, or Portal Users (Customers), and save the settings.

C. Building the project stages and milestones

1. Open "Edit Stages" and add stages such as: Planning, Execution, Review, Delivery.
2. You can link each stage to a specific condition or statement, if required. Note that you also have the option to activate the "Required fields".

3. Create key Milestones: "Design Completed", "Sample Approved", "Final Delivery".
4. Save the changes and make sure the columns appear in the "Kanban" interface.

D. Creating and distributing tasks (Tasks & Assignment)

1. From the "Tasks" tab, click "Create Task", enter the name and description.
2. Define the current stage, assign staff (Assignee), and set the Priority and Deadline.
3. Add Collaborators to track comments and attachments.
4. Save the task and check that it appears in the correct column.

E. Relationships between tasks (Dependencies) and sub-tasks

1. Open the target task and add Predecessors (tasks that must be completed before starting).
2. Use the "Gantt" interface to view the timeline and interrelationship between tasks.
3. When you need to break down the work, create Sub-Tasks with separate deadlines.
4. Review the impact of dependencies on timeframes in planning.

F. Time and Effort Recording (Timesheets)

1. Within each task, open the "Timesheets" tab.
2. Press Start/Stop to record the time or manually enter the hours with a description.
3. Check the total hours for each user and for the entire project from the "Timesheets" report.
4. Make sure the hours are compatible with the "Planned Hours" to adjust performance.

G. Planning and Resource Allocation (Planning Integration)

1. Open the "Planning" app and select the desired project.
2. Create shifts/allocations for team members based on availability and skills.
3. Link the allocation to tasks or phases so that it appears in their schedules.
4. Review schedule conflicts and update priorities to reduce congestion.

H. Templates & Recurring Tasks

1. Save the sample project as a Project Template for reuse.
2. Within the task, activate the "Recurring" feature and specify the recurrence: daily/weekly/monthly.
3. Review the automatically generated copies and make sure of their dates.
4. Stop repeating when the cycle is complete or the need changes.

I. Documents & Discuss

1. Attach the specifications and drawings files within the task or project as "Attachments".
2. Use Documents to create a Workspace for the project and categorize files with "Tags".
3. Record the technical discussions via "Internal Messages" within the task to gather the decision and context.
4. Use the "Mentions" feature to notify those concerned and document the follow-up.

J. Scheduling and Appointments

1. Open the Calendar and create meetings for the design, follow-up, and approval phases.
2. Link the event to the project/task and identify the participants and the objective.
3. Activate "Reminders" and "Invitations".
4. Write down the minutes of the meeting in "Notes" and attach them to the task.

K. Monitoring and Analysis Panel (Dashboard)

1. Review the Dashboard for completion rates, adherence to deadlines, and hours spent.
2. Switch between Kanban/List/Gantt/Calendar viewports for different viewing angles.
3. Apply the "Filters" and "Group By" according to stage, administrator, or priority.
4. Identify the stalled projects and take immediate corrective action.

L. Billing and accounting for payable projects

1. Activate the "Billable" feature in the project settings.
2. Link the "Timesheets" to the billing rates for the resources/roles.
3. Create an invoice for the project based on the hours or stages completed.
4. Review the accounting constraints and the "Total Cost" of the project.

M. Notifications & Automations

1. Enable email/chat notifications when task status changes.
2. Create "Automated Actions" such as (Automatic Assignment, Deadline Near Reminder, Phase Change).
3. Reuse the same Rule Sets across projects to standardize behavior.
4. Observe the effect of automation on reducing manual delays.

N. Closure & Archiving

1. Make sure that all tasks are completed and parameters are closed.
2. Change the project status to "Done" and write down closing notes.
3. Archive the final documents within the project Workspace for supervisory purposes.

1.5 Key Performance Indicators (KPIs)

Index	Translation	Equation	Target
Project Completion Rate (Percentage)	نسبة الإنجاز أو إتمام المشروع	$(\text{Number of completed tasks}) \div (\text{Total tasks}) \times 100$	$\geq 95\%$
On-Time Delivery Rate (Deadline Compliance Rate)	معدل الالتزام بالوقت المحدد للتسليم	$(\text{Number of projects completed on time}) \div (\text{Total projects}) \times 100$	$\geq 90\%$
Time Utilization Efficiency	مقارنة الوقت الفعلي بالمخطط	$(\text{Actual hours} \div \text{Planned hours}) \times 100$	$\leq 100\%$
Budget Accuracy	معدل الفرق بين التكلفة الفعلية والمخططة	$(\text{Actual cost} \div \text{Planned cost}) \times 100$	$\leq \pm 10\%$
Human Resources Utilization Rate	معدل استفادة الشركة من وقت الموظفين	$(\text{Recorded hours} \div \text{Allocated hours}) \times 100$	$\geq 85\%$
Customer Satisfaction Index	متوسط تقييم العملاء للمشروعات	$(\text{Total rating score} \div \text{Number of customers}) \times 100$	$\geq 90\%$

1.6 Frequently Asked Questions (FAQ)

Q: Is it possible to manage more than one project at the same time?

Yes, an unlimited number of projects can be run simultaneously, with dedicated phases, members, and resources for each project. The "Projects Overview" panel allows you to monitor all projects in real time in one place.

Q: Can the project be linked to other modules such as manufacturing or sales?

Yes, the Projects module is a key integration point with other modules such as manufacturing, accounting and sales. Manufacturing phases and costs can be tracked directly from within the project without the need to duplicate data.

Q: How can the time an employee spends within the project be monitored?

Through the Timesheets module, employees record their daily working hours, and these hours are automatically linked to performance reports and the actual cost of the project.

Q: What is the benefit of the Dashboard analysis panel?

The analytical dashboard is used to monitor key performance indicators such as completion rate, time commitment, and overdue tasks, and helps management make immediate decisions based on accurate and direct data.

Q: Can meetings and notes be documented within the project?

Yes, through the Notes module for recording meeting minutes and daily decisions, and the notes are directly linked to the project or task to facilitate referencing them later.

Q: Does the system issue notifications when tasks are delayed?

The Automated Actions feature can be enabled to send instant email or system alerts when task deadlines are approaching or have passed.

Q: How is the project closed after it is completed?

Upon completion of all tasks and phases, the results are approved by the project manager, the

project status is then changed to Done, and it is automatically archived within the system with all notes and attachments saved.

1.7 The Project Manager's Daily Checklist

1. Check the status of each open project and determine the current progress level and remaining stages.
2. Review the tasks that are high priority or close to the deadline, and make sure that the required resources are available.
3. Check the tasks completed by the team during the day, approve them, and move them to the next stage.
4. Check the hours entered in the Timesheets and make sure they match the actual working hours at the factory.
5. Keep track of system notifications regarding overdue tasks or changes made to projects.
6. Add your operational notes in the Notes section to document decisions or problems that have been addressed.
7. Review the daily performance indicators (time, achievement, resources) and identify any deviations from the plan.
8. Check that all updated engineering drawings and contracts have been uploaded to the Documents module.
9. Review the Planning table to allocate individuals according to priorities and ensure that the teams are ready.